Your free community magazine about Thamesmead

thamesview

www.gallionsha.co.uk

June 06

Inside this issue



Cycle Thamesmead


Fishing club


World Cup 06

Simon Webbe finds 'Sanctuary' in Thamesmead



Editorial

Whether you like it or not our TV screens and newspapers will be full of nothing but football this month. Even if you are not interested in football at all, it is hard not to get swept away with the country's enthusiasm and excitement. In keeping with this growing atmosphere of anticipation, this month's Thamesview has dedicated a few pages to the nation's favourite pastime. However, In the interest of fairness we have also included some information about Thamesmead's many cycle routes. If you would be happy never to see another football again well now is a good time to dust down your bike and discover some new local sights.

Complaints Contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A step-by-step guide is available on the Gallions website under the 'contact us' section. You may also get in touch with the Complaints Management team who will advise you what action to take. Your feedback is important to Gallions.

complaints@gallionsha.co.uk
www.gallionsha.co.uk
0800 83 84 81

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Canal Clean Up

Gallions and Thames 21 are now running monthly river clean up events in and around Thamesmead. This month's litter blitz will take place on Saturday 24th June at Hutchins Road. Volunteers are asked to meet on the Green outside Woolwich Polytechnic at 11am.

Customer Contacts Number

Gallions call centre is sometimes closed during office hours for staff training. To ensure your service continues as normal, all calls are automatically forwarded to Amicus, Gallions emergency repair service.

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ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਬੋਲੀ ਹੇਠਾਂ ਲਾਗ ਦੇ ਨਾਲ ਦੇ ਨੰਤੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਬਾਕੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਦੇ, ਅਤੇ ਫੇਸੀ ਹੇਠੀ ਦਾ ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਦੇ ਇਹ ਫਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਖਾਰੀ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਉ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

Punjabi ○ Chinese ○ Vietnamese ○
(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

New Neighbourhood Services teams

The latest development in Gallions drive to deliver an outstanding neighbourhood management service sees the creation of a number of new Neighbourhood Services teams.

Building on the success of the patch-team approach, Gallions has brought together Neighbourhood Wardens, Neighbourhood Co-ordinators and Rehousing staff. This new structure will help create clearer lines of communication and encourage joint problem solving. It will enable staff to tackle local problems with local solutions quickly and efficiently. Sharon McGregor, Gallions Head of Neighbourhood Services says:

"By merging these roles into patch-based teams we are taking a more streamlined approach to problem-solving. Issues will no longer be looked at in isolation but will now have a variety of resources available."

Gallions will be continuing to run their patch team meetings, neighbourhood forums and estate walkabouts. If you would like more information please call 0800 83 84 81.

Let's talk about pigeons

To some they are a harmless hobby while others view them with horror. Either way they are a big health hazard. While pigeons are a part of life they are now becoming a real problem in Thamesmead.

They are creatures of habit and will return year after year to the same place. Team Gallions are constantly spending time and money clearing up the unsightly and unhygienic pigeon mess. The message is clear – please do not feed the pigeons.

Talented Thamesmead team scoops top prize

Congratulations to the Thamesmead Boyz football team who scooped the top prize at the Wolvercote Road Ball Court League. This was the second season of the ball court league and was, once again, a big success. Runners up were Classic 6 another talented team of players from Thamesmead. The league is part of Bexley's Areas of Opportunity programme and is supported by Charlton Athletic Football Club, the Community Safety Action Zone, Gallions, Safer Neighbourhoods and the Metropolitan police. With the prize donated by the News Shopper it is a great example of partnership working in practice.

GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD

GRB Elections coming soon

You will shortly be receiving information about this year's Gallions Resident Board elections that are being held on Thursday 27th July.

The GRB are currently looking for new members to join a team that can really make a difference in your area. It is a great opportunity for a tenant or a leaseholder to help shape the community and to improve the quality of life for all Thamesmead residents. Working closely with Gallions Housing Association, the GRB aims to make Thamesmead a better place to have your home.

If you are interested in joining the GRB and are willing to give up some of your spare time for the community, full nomination details can be found in the election pack that has been sent to all residents and leaseholders.

Opportunities for training and development will be made available to you, to help you make the difference.

DEALING WITH DEBT

Is debt becoming a problem for you?

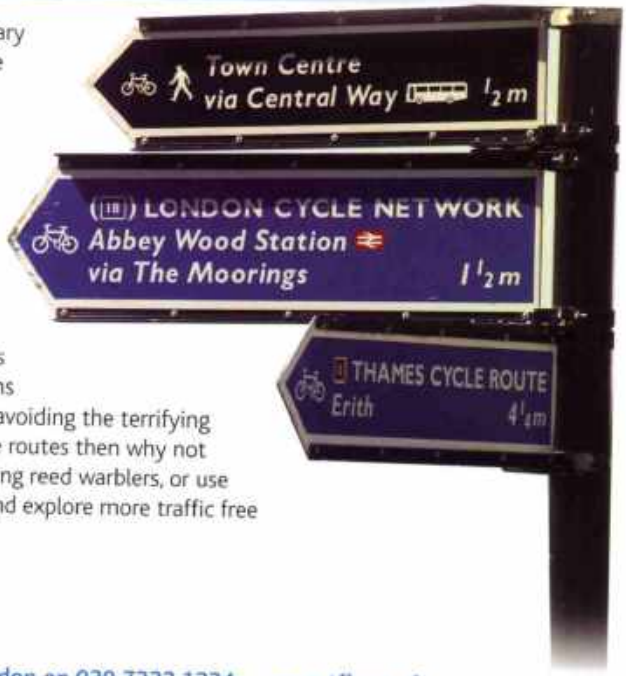
Are you having trouble meeting your financial commitments? Then why not get in touch with Gallions Debt Helpline. Specialist advisers will be in touch to discuss your options.

DEBT HELPLINE
0208 320 3687

DEAL WITH DEBT, DON'T IGNORE IT.

CYCLING NEWS

Did you know that you can cycle from Thamesmead to Canary Wharf on a mainly traffic free route and that the cycle route extends the other way to Dover? Frances Renton from the local London Cycling Club gives us a flavour of what's out there for Thamesmead's cyclists.



Thamesmead enjoys a fabulous network of waterways and lakes. Running alongside these waterways are a number of quiet and pleasant cycle routes from Thamesmead to the Thames Path. Determined that as many people as possible can enjoy these routes we got together with Team Gallions and Sustrans, the charity who developed the Thames Cycle Path. One cold January day we were able to put up signs directing cyclists to the Thames Path using quiet routes and avoiding the terrifying Eastern Way roundabout. If you haven't been round the cycle routes then why not give it a go? Come and see the waving reeds, hear the chittering reed warblers, or use the route to get to Woolwich where you can cross the river and explore more traffic free routes or just watch the planes take off at City Airport.

More information

- For a free London cycling guide contact **Transport for London on 020 7222 1234** or **www.tfl.gov.uk.**
- For information on local groups or family cycling contact the London Cycling Campaign, 020 7928 7220 or **www.lcc.org.uk**
- For information on Sustrans routes see their website www.sustrans.org.uk.
- If you have suggestions about further improvements you would like to see for cyclists contact **robert.clark@bexley.gov.uk.**
- If you are not confident cycling and would like to cycle with someone to increase your confidence, contact Frances Renton from the local LCC group, **f.renton@gold.ac.uk**

Watching the Wardens

This summer looks set to be a good one with Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens planning a whole host of activities for Thamesmead's young people. The ever-popular remote controlled car club will be kicking into gear in August while a series of summer games such as rounders and cricket will be being played out in the parks and open spaces. Enthusiastic fishers will not be disappointed as the fishing club will continue throughout the long summer evenings. This summer there is even a 'fishing week' with extended activities and events. Summer 2006 however would not be complete without a football tournament and Thamesmead residents can look forward to their very own World Cup style football tournament. **For more information please contact the Neighbourhood Wardens on 0800 83 84 81.**

Success is catching

Gallions Fishing Club has really taken off with more and more people joining every week. Launched originally by Phil Briggs one of Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens, today the club is run in partnership with Thamesmead Town Angling Club and Thames 21. An experienced fisher himself, Phil is teaching Thamesmead's youngsters the art of fishing. And with some success judging by our picture! Phil's young charges were celebrating their biggest catch to date - a 12.5lb carp.

For more information about joining the fishing club please call Gallions freephone 0800 83 84 81.



Mingle with the stars



Simon Webbe, Chico and Brenda are coming to town.

It's that time of the year again when the stars get ready to strut their stuff on Thamesmead's biggest stage. The Trust Thamesmead Festival will once again rock to the sound of some of some of today's most popular acts.



And we are giving one lucky reader aged 16 years or under, the chance to see what goes on backstage.

Would you like to snuggle up to Simon Webb, chat to Chico or banter with Brenda from The X Factor? By entering Thamesview's exclusive competition you could see the stars as you've never seen them before, strolling backstage without a care in the world. All you have to do is correctly answer the question below. Make sure you keep Saturday 15th July free because you, your parent or guardian and two of your friends could be clutching backstage passes and rubbing shoulders with the stars.

To enter you must be 16 years or under and live at home with a Gallions resident. Five runners up will each win a signed copy of Simon Webbe's debut solo album, Sanctuary.

QUESTION: In which boy band did Simon Webbe shoot to fame?

Answer: ----------

Name: ----------

Address: ----------

Parent/Guardian's name: ----------

Telephone number: ----------

Please complete the form and return it no later than Monday 19 June 2006.

Send your entry to Joy McKee at Gallions Housing Association, 3 Hurst Road, Sidcup, London, SE2 9XH or email jmckee@gallionsha.co.uk with your entry and personal details.
We will contact the winner week beginning 26th June 2006.

The winner must be aged 16 or under and must be accompanied by an adult. The winner may nominate two guests (maximum of 4 people in winning group). The prize is non-transferable.





FIFA World Cup Germany

First Round - Match Schedule

With the World Cup now only days away, the whole country is going football crazy. And, with many pundits now saying that this year England has a real chance of lifting the coveted cup, the excitement is set to reach fever pitch. To make sure you don't miss any of the action The Princess Alice on Battery Road is showing all of England's matches on a big screen.

What's more, with a special deal on pitchers of lager and Pimms you can celebrate (or commiserate) to your hearts content. The Cutty Sark in the town centre will also be showing England's matches on a plasma TV screen. The scene is set for a great tournament so sit back and enjoy it wherever you are.

	09.06.06 Friday	10.06.06 Saturday	11.06.06 Sunday	12.06.06 Monday	13.06.06 Tuesday	14.06.06 Wednesday	15.06.06 Thursday	16.06.06 Friday	17.06.06 Saturday	18.06.06 Sunday	19.06.06 Monday	20.06.06 Tuesday	21.06.06 Wednesday	22.06.06 Thursday	23.06.06 Friday
Berlin					Match 11 BRA - CRO 20:00 hrs		Match 20 SWE - PAR 20:00 hrs					Match 33 ECU - GER 15:00 hrs			Match 48 UKR - TUN 15:00 hrs
Dortmund		Match 4 TRI - SWE 17:00 hrs				Match 17 GER - POL 20:00 hrs					Match 30 TOG - SUI 14:00 hrs			Match 43 JPN - BRA 20:00 hrs	
Frankfurt		Match 3 ENG - PAR 14:00 hrs			Match 14 KOR - TOG 14:00 hrs				Match 24 POR - IRN 14:00 hrs				Match 37 NED - ARG 20:00 hrs		
Gelsenkirchen	Match 2 POL - ECU 20:00 hrs			Match 10 USA - CZE 17:00 hrs				Match 21 ARG - SCG 14:00 hrs					Match 39 POR - MEX 15:00 hrs		
Hamburg		Match 5 ARG - CIV 20:00 hrs					Match 18 ECU - CRC 14:00 hrs				Match 32 KSA - UKR 17:00 hrs			Match 41 CZE - ITA 15:00 hrs	
Hanover				Match 9 ITA - GHA 20:00 hrs				Match 23 MEX - ANG 20:00 hrs				Match 34 CRC - POL 15:00 hrs			Match 46 SUI - KOR 20:00 hrs
Kaiserslautern				Match 12 AUS - JPN 14:00 hrs					Match 25 ITA - USA 20:00 hrs			Match 36 PAR - TRI 20:00 hrs			Match 47 KSA - ESP 15:00 hrs
Cologne			Match 8 ANG - POR 20:00 hrs						Match 26 CZE - GHA 17:00 hrs			Match 35 SWE - ENG 20:00 hrs			Match 45 TOG - FRA 20:00 hrs
Leipzig			Match 6 SCG - NED 14:00 hrs			Match 15 ESP - UKR 14:00 hrs				Match 29 FRA - KOR 20:00 hrs			Match 40 IRN - ANG 15:00 hrs		
Munich	Match 1 GER - CRC 17:00 hrs					Match 16 TUN - KSA 17:00 hrs				Match 27 BRA - AUS 17:00 hrs			Match 38 CIV - SCG 20:00 hrs		
Nuremberg			Match 7 MEX - IRN 17:00 hrs				Match 19 ENG - TRI 17:00 hrs			Match 28 JPN - CRO 14:00 hrs				Match 42 GHA - USA 15:00 hrs	
Stuttgart					Match 13 FRA - SUI 17:00 hrs			Match 22 NED - CIV 17:00 hrs			Match 31 ESP - TUN 20:00 hrs			Match 44 CRO - AUS 20:00 hrs	

Football CRAZY

From Trinidad and Tobago to the mighty Brazil, the next month will see 32 nations battling it out for the greatest prize in football. With each of the tournament's 64 football matches expected to be watched by some 500 million people it is sure to be a spectacular competition. This month Thamesview takes a brief look at the history of the World Cup.



1. The first World Cup was held in 1930.

5. The latest goal in a World Cup match was scored by David Platt in 1990 in the 119th minute!



9. The 2006 World Cup will be held in Germany.



2. 199,850 people crammed into a stadium in Brazil in 1950 to watch Brazil vs Uruguay – the largest crowd on record!



6. The last time Germany hosted the World Cup was in 1974.

10. The famous Jules Rimet trophy was stolen just before the 1966 World Cup- it was found in London wrapped in newspaper by a dog named Pickles!

3. The smallest crowd was made up of only 300 people who watched Romania vs Peru in Uruguay for the 1930 World Cup.



7. In 1983 the Jules Rimet trophy was stolen again and has not been found to this day.



11. This year, for the first time ever, all seats will be under cover.



4. The World Cup's all-time highest goal scorer is the German Gerd Müller who scored 14 goals between 1966 and 1974.

8. The first World Cup Mascot, World Cup Willie, appeared when England hosted the World Cup in 1966.



12. The next World Cup will be held in South Africa in 2010.

WHAT'S ON AT TAVY BRIDGE

At the Tavy Bridge Project Office there are many FREE advice centres and groups that are there to help you. Along with information about the progress of the area's regeneration, there are a number of other meetings and sessions that may be of interest to you.

Welfare Benefits Advice

Gallions specialist advisor Derek Stainsby is on hand to make sure residents are receiving their full entitlement to housing benefits, social security benefits and tax credits.

He runs a session from the project office every 2nd Wednesday of each month from 10am until 4pm.

Neighbourhood Advice Sessions

Gallions Neighbourhood Warden's and Housing Co-Ordinators are available at the project office every Thursday afternoon from 3:30pm to 5pm to discuss any problems or concerns you have.

Employment Service

Trust Thamesmead's Building Futures project now runs a session every Tuesday from 10.00am to 12.30pm help you seek employment.

Legal Advice

Law Centre volunteers and trained welfare rights advisors will be available to discuss any queries you have or to give advice every Tuesday from 1.30pm to 3.30pm

There is no need to book to attend these meetings - just come along to the project office on the days and times that suit you.

Green light for the health centre

Tavy Bridge residents are very much looking forward to the arrival of their new health centre. Bringing a wider range of medical services to the very heart of the community the new Lakeside Health Centre will form part of the public main square in Tavy Bridge. Work is scheduled to start towards the end of this summer and it is hoped that the health centre will open its doors in November 2007.

The site for the Lakeside Health Centre is just off the west boundary of the Tavy Bridge area. Highly visible and accessible it is likely that the new building will not only become a landmark along Yarnton Way but it will also stand as a symbol for the wider community regeneration. Designed over three floors with space on the ground floor for GPs and training facilities, the first floor will house the specialist community dental facility and other treatment areas while the remaining space will be allocated to Community Nursing and District Nursing teams.

Linda Harris, Gallions Resident Liaison Officer says: "*The new health centre will be a community-friendly building offering a much wider range of services. The existing centre will not be closed down until the new Lakeside Health Centre is fully operational ensuring that residents receive uninterrupted services.*"



meet the team

Maintaining high standards

Determined to provide residents with an excellent maintenance and repairs programme, Gallions Asset Management team are delighted to have signed a long-term partnerning contract with Axis Europe Plc. Together they will work hard to deliver a streamlined service, where residents' needs come first.

Gallions Asset Management



Terry Bird (pictured)
Head of Asset Management
tbird@gallionsha.co.uk

Terry joined Gallions in February 2005 bringing with him some 27 years experience in the construction industry. As Head of Asset Management, Terry's role includes putting in place a strategy to deliver repairs and investment services.
He is also responsible for making sure that Gallions meets the government's Decent Homes standards and deadlines. Since his arrival Terry and his team have been very focused on improving services for residents. The introduction of the 'Right First Time' repair service in October 2005 has gone a long way in raising standards.

"There are 10 people in the asset management team and together we are all working towards meeting the same goal – providing residents with an outstanding repairs and maintenance programme. We have recently signed a 14-year agreement with Axis Europe Plc, an organisation that shares the same core values as Gallions. This long-term partnership is the cornerstone of our programme and shows residents an exceptional level of commitment. Everyone within the team, whatever their role, makes sure that residents' needs are put first."

Paul Monforte
Asset Manager
pmonforte@gallionsha.co.uk

Paul is responsible for delivery of Gallions Investment and Planned Maintenance works programme both current and future. His primary concern is to ensure that Gallions is well equipped to complete the works required as part of the governments Decent Homes Targets in 2010.

Working closely with Axis and its sub-contractors Paul oversees the relationship to ensure that the partnering contract consistently delivers high standards of property repairs, maintenance and improvement. He is responsible for making sure that work is carried out within agreed resources and with high levels of customer satisfaction.

Gwen Mhuriro
Asset Management Coordinator
gmhuriro@gallionsha.co.uk

Gwen joined the maintenance department of Gallions in August 2001. Her main role is to manage void properties within Asset Management including monitoring Axis' performance. Gwen works closely with Axis and the Allocations team. Any enquiries regarding voids, rechargeable repairs and decorating schemes for the elderly and disabled will be handled by Gwen.
Gwen also provides administrative support to the Asset Management team. She has established, develops and maintains effective working relationships with residents, contractors, and colleagues to ensure an integrated contribution towards meeting performance targets.

Dave West
Building Surveyor
dwest@gallionsha.co.uk

Having worked in the maintenance department of first Thamesmead Town and then Gallions, Dave is one of the most experienced and most helpful members of staff.
Dave focuses mainly on post inspections of repairs and void works that have already been carried out. These quality control inspections ensure that all completed works and contractors' performance are carefully monitored.

Dave is also responsible for supervising and liaising effectively with Axis when carrying out repairs to ensure they are carried out correctly and to prescribed standards and timescales. It is Dave who responds to requests from tenants to assess the need for any repairs improvements and safety checks.

Carol Rayner
Gas Safety Co-ordinator
crayner@gallionsha.co.uk

Since Carol joined the team in January 2006 she has made significant improvements to Gas Safety Maintenance. Her role is to ensure all attempts to gain access to carry out the gas safety check are made in accordance with policy, liaising with Interserve our Gas contractor, internal departments and solicitors as necessary.

Carol acts as an intermediary between residents, colleagues, contractors and external agencies to ensure continuous improvement of the gas and repairs service generally. She represents Gallions at County Courts in respect of seeking injunctions to gain access to carry out these safety checks.

Young People

Cave Climbing Wall
Thamesmead's climbing wall is an excellent way to learn a new skill or to improve on your climbing technique. **www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk**
Tel: 0208 320 4494

Fun Club
Glimpsing Green
Saturday morning fun for children up to 11 who have a disability or a special need.
Tel: 020 8311 6777

Brownies
Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 7 to 11
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Guides
Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 11+
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Greenmeade Community Hall
- *Carer & Child Drop-in*
- *Sunshine Club for children with autism*

Tel: 0208 303 1006

Rainbows
Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 5 to 11 years

Brownies
Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 7 to 11 years
Tel: 0208 244 3488
07958 967902
e. sandy.white70@ntlworld.com

New Acres Library Tavy Bridge
Tel: 020 8311 5291

- *Baby Time*
  Nursery rhymes, singing, stories for the under 4's and their parents.
- *Family Learning*
  For children 5 + years and their parents.
- *Story Time*
  For children 3 to 5 years and their parents.
- *Teenage Reading Group*
  Fun activities to help teenagers discover books.

Music and Dance

Myztikal
Church of the Cross Hall
Lensbury Way
Street dance classes
ages 8 to 15
Tel: 07956 949249

Theatre Street
Broadwater Village Hall
Gooseander Way
Dancing, singing and drama
Tel: 01322 441977
Web: www.theatrestreet.com

Youth Advisory Project
Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
Music for 16 to 24 years old
Tel: 020 8311 5111

Clubs and Groups for the Elderly

Over 50's Bingo Club
Greenmeade Community Hall
Monday and Thursday
7.30 to 9pm
Tel: 0208 303 1006

Pop-In Parlour
Evenlode House
Coralline Walk
Tel: 020 8310 7437

Teeswater Atrium
Variety of groups and activities 7 days a week Including Bingo, darts, sewing, ballroom and line dancing and an African social group.
Tel: 0800 83 84 81

After School Clubs

Birchmere Club
Near *Disraeli Close*
Tel: 020 8311 8886

Hawksmoor Youth Club
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8312 4022

Heronsgate Club
Whinchat Road
Tel: 07950612826

Playgroups

Goose-e-ganders
Parent and Toddler group.
Tel: 07958 640645

Toddles
Manor Close Community Hall
Manor Close
Tel: 020 8310 9004

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School
Senior Citizens Hall,
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 07950 853481

To list your group please contact Joy Mckee on 0208 320 3414

Get fit with your friends

The Atrium at Teeswater Court is the venue for a new Wednesday evening 'sit down' exercise class. Aimed at more mature ladies (although open to all) a qualified tutor will take the class through a series of gentle exercises that can all be carried out sitting down. Why not come along and enjoy yourself getting fit from the comfort of your chair.



For more information please call Mr Dennis Thompson-Mason on 0208 333 2002

Wednesday evenings 4.30pm to 5.30pm - The Atrium, Teeswater Court

The new change Programme

Easy as *ABC*

small change : big difference
change

Change is a partnership of twelve housing associations throughout the London area and our aim is to help you make the most of your money. Over the last three years we have been working to help you get better access to information, support and advice on money matters. Since launch we have been able to help many people by providing practical advice to sort out debts, to offer training to support better money management and to run a scheme opening new credit union savings and loan accounts.

Change is now developing a further range of much needed financial services.

Research has shown us that many residents must manage on low incomes and may not have any savings. What's more is that many people do not have a bank account or a credit rating that allows them to borrow money from banks. Statistics show that those living in rented homes are more likely to borrow money from doorstep lenders or loan sharks, where interest rates can be as high as 177%.

A is for advice

Change offers general advice about money matters including such areas as budgeting, basic debt advice, paying bills by direct debit and information about welfare benefits and tax credits. Specialist advisors from Change will talk to you about your situation and identify and agree a plan of action to help you move forward.

B is for Banking

Change will encourage people without bank accounts to open one. We will talk you through your options and help you decide on which bank account best suits your needs. Basic bank accounts are easy to open and offer no access to credit, making it impossible for your account to become overdrawn. With a bank account in place we will help you set up direct debits and see if you can make savings on your bills.

C is for Credit

Change is running a pilot scheme in Greenwich and Bexley that looks at providing affordable personal loans. All applications will be individually assessed to establish whether your income and outgoings will mean you can afford the repayments. Loans will be made available only in specific circumstances such as essential purchases, funds for training or return to work costs, or consolidating debts.

This is the first time housing associations have offered this range of financial services across London. For more information please contact the Change hotline on 020 8535 2960 or visit www.changefinance.org.uk or email Change@lqgroup.org.uk

DIRECT DEBIT DRAW

Gallions is offering all those residents who pay their rent by direct debit the opportunity to enter a free prize draw. Watch out for more details in next month's Thamesview.

DIRECT Debit

For more information about setting up a direct debit call Gallions freephone on 0800 83 84 81 or drop in Gallions office in Harrow Manor Way and ask for a direct debit application form.

TAKE A BREAK

The lucky winner will collect £25 worth of WHSmith vouchers.

On your bike In amongst this month's football frenzy you may have noticed that 17th June is the start of national bike week. So why not take a break from the television and have a go at Thamesview's word search. You won't find a football or a foul there!

REFLECTOR
HANDLEBAR
TYRE
BRAKE
SEAT
GEARS
BICYCLE
BELL
WHEEL
PUMP
HELMET
SPOKE

E	E	A	T	E	M	L	E	H	R	R	E	Y	T	H	R	R	E	E	B	Y
R	R	T	E	U	O	E	K	I	A	A	U	B	R	E	S	T	L	S	L	O
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S	P	O	K	E	E	L	T	L	A	B	A	M	B	P	S	E	E	E	O	E
R	P	C	S	K	K	Y	E	E	E	E	Y	S	R	L	K	R	N	S	A	C
R	U	E	T	H	R	D	R	B	K	N	S	L	L	P	R	B	L	E	A	B
E	P	G	P	E	B	H	A	N	D	L	E	B	A	R	T	L	G	L	O	L
U	U	H	E	H	H	C	E	S	R	B	K	L	D	S	L	S	B	E	E	T
E	U	W	H	T	T	E	I	E	I	E	A	K	L	R	E	P	Y	E	P	L
E	L	L	N	Y	T	E	C	C	L	T	R	O	E	C	K	E	T	H	U	E
E	B	D	W	R	R	P	Y	U	B	R	B	H	C	E	T	C	C	W	M	D
R	E	H	A	R	P	C	R	L	E	T	E	B	P	C	T	E	R	U	P	R
F	L	E	B	A	L	T	F	T	E	R	E	F	L	E	C	T	O	R	E	A
R	K	N	L	E	O	E	P	L	E	T	E	A	T	T	R	L	E	D	Y	E
P	R	D	D	L	F	L	E	T	S	R	A	E	G	Y	L	T	E	T	S	E
S	E	U	E	C	O	L	T	R	A	F	C	E	C	B	H	P	L	L	C	T

Name

Address

Telephone

Just send in your correctly completed word search to the address below, along with your name and address, by 23rd June. The winner's name will be pulled out of a hat. Word Search Competition, FAO Marie Dunster, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH or drop the entry into Gallions reception.

LOCAL Listings

Chemists

Whinchat Chemist
1 Whinchat Road,
Tel: 0208 333 5000

A F Browne Chemist
4 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0208 310 7209

Churches

Christian Life Centre
11 Arnott Close
Tel: 020 8310 5361

St Paul's Ecumenical Church
Bentham Road,
Tel: 020 8310 6814

Titmuss Avenue
Baptist Church
85 Titmuss Avenue
Tel: 020 8310 1683

Power Light Evangelism
2c Goosander Way
Tel: 0208 310 9149
powerlightevang@aol.com

Open Gateway United Church
62-64 Battery Road
Tel 0208 836 9069

Dentists

Gallions Reach Dental
Anaesthetic Clinic
Heronsgate Dental Centre
1b Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8316 6313

Vijay Vithani
12 Joyce Dawson Way
Tel: 020 8311 9400
Lakeside Dental Practice
69 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0844 4778966

Doctors

Heronsgate Medical Centre
1a Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8333 5050

Gallions Reach Health Centre
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8333 5000

Lakeside Health Centre
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0208 8310 3045

Hospitals

Queen Elizabeth Hospital
Stadium Road, Woolwich
Tel: 020 8836 6000

Queen Mary's Hospital
Frognal Avenue, Sidcup
Tel: 020 8302 2678

Transport

National Rail Enquiries
Tel: 08457 484950

London Travel Information
Tel: 020 7222 1234

TEE OFF YOUR NEW LIFE

It could be love on the putting green as Thamesview Golf Centre, Fairway Drive, Thamesmead, has applied to Bexley Council to become an approved venue for weddings.

Did you know?

The day after the May Day bank holiday, Gallions Customer Contact Team received a staggering 40% extra calls.